



MONTHLY UPDATE

Tanzania: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 73 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION

Summary of the month

Payments carried the month. An [order under the electronic transactions Act](#) came into operation on 1 July 2026, making nine scheduled classes of transaction electronic-payment-only; on [31 July the central bank set caps on several retail charges and its governor rejected a general price cap](#), saying charges are already low and competition will cut fees within six months.

The ICT ministry set out an artificial-intelligence position abroad before adopting one at home. At an international meeting on 18 July it stated that a [national AI data centre is under construction and that a Kiswahili large language model is written into the 2050 vision](#); on 30 July guidelines were still being drafted.

A ministerial inspection of the national backbone on 24 July recorded [942.5 km built in one region against 65 citizens connected region-wide](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

At a university health conference on 31 July the government stated [three requirements: that health data be stored inside Tanzania, that healthcare AI systems be approved by the relevant authorities, and that local capacity to build them be developed](#). No instrument and no approving authority was named, and a dedicated regulator was called for from the floor rather than announced.

The coordination that did get a name came from outside the state. A [multi-stakeholder body launched on 8 August to coordinate cybersecurity, data privacy, artificial-intelligence governance and payment security across government, industry and academia](#), founded by a security firm with a privacy professionals' association and a fintech association, and naming the data protection commission, the ICT commission and the private sector federation among its partners; the [same forum published a digital trust outlook report and inaugurated a cross-border corridor with the Gulf Cooperation Council for regulatory dialogue, secure payments and artificial-intelligence governance](#). No constitution, funding, membership list or statement of the named regulators' role in it is held.

Legislation and regulation

The legislative response to all of this is a review rather than a bill. The government says it will [review more than 1,000 laws, including the public-private partnership act, the companies act and financial legislation, to build a regulatory framework supporting artificial intelligence, digital commerce and technology investment under the 2050](#)

development vision. No list of statutes, sequencing, responsible body, timetable or consultation route is stated — and the base still records no online-content or cybercrime regulation for the country, and no adopted artificial-intelligence strategy.

Data protection

The data protection commission and the open university [opened a certification programme for data protection officers on 14 July](#), the university training and assessing and the commission certifying, aimed at government, finance, telecommunications, healthcare, education and technology. It answers the statutory officer duty; no intake number, fee or cohort date was published.

A separate rule pulls in the other direction. Businesses selling on social media must now [display tax credentials — a taxpayer identification number, tax clearance certificate or certificate of registration — on their public pages](#), and digital creators and online traders have objected that publishing those credentials exposes them to impersonation and fraud (12 August). The objections are those of named creators and traders reported by the paper rather than a regulator finding; no data-protection assessment or redress route is published.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The month's one finding about political speech came from outside the state. A civil-society research organisation [documented online gendered violence against election candidates as cyclical across successive elections in Tanzania and Côte d'Ivoire](#), timed to a national election period. No regulator, electoral commission or platform publishes a comparable measurement, so the only quantification of the problem the record holds is the researcher's own.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

Three external tracks opened in one week, none priced. On 17 July [cooperation frameworks were agreed with Brazil and Poland on AI strategy, digital government and cybersecurity research](#), with memoranda proposed and none signed; [youth and technology-skills agreements with Russia were in drafting](#). On 24 July the ministry's permanent secretary signed a [memorandum in Shanghai covering ICT infrastructure, AI, digital public service infrastructure, developing local professionals, and manufacture and assembly of digital equipment](#). The ministry's own release states no commitment amount, term or financing structure.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The minister inspected the national backbone at Mpwapwa on 24 July. The network stands at about [14,000 km carrying four public data centres and a third landing cable](#); in the region inspected, 942.5 km had been built against 65 people connected. The regional manager stated that phase one connected government offices and public institutions, with individual citizens next. At the same inspection [636 masts were stated due in March 2027, with a second programme of 280 masts under way](#) with no cost, financier or completion date given.

On 29 July the Kenyan and Tanzanian ministers [launched a terrestrial fibre link across the border, integrating the national backbone with submarine cable capacity](#). No capacity, cost or financing was stated, and the base does not reconcile it against the 2025 connection on the route.

A separate tower programme reported its own reach to Parliament on 15 August: a [TZS 126bn, 758-tower project – TZS 55bn from the World Bank and TZS 71bn from the universal service fund](#) – has connected 8.5 million people across 1,400 villages, in the same report that records 14,826 data controllers and processors registered with the data protection commission by June 2026. The ministry gives no count of towers completed against the 758 planned, and no measure of service uptake in the villages it says are connected.

Data Storage

A data-centre group named its Tanzanian site as under development while raising [committed capital from US\\$350m to US\\$380m](#), giving no Tanzanian size, cost or date.

A sector review of 5 August put a count on what is already there: [ten data centres in Dar es Salaam and one in Dodoma, operated by six carriers](#). It is a count and nothing more – no capacity, load or utilisation accompanies it – and it is a trade magazine's rather than the regulator's, so it does not replace the state's own count of public centres commissioned.

Technical Capacity

The state operator [gave students of a technical institute hands-on training on backbone technologies](#), reported 23 July with no intake number or cadence.

Cybersecurity

One investigation put numbers on SIM-registration fraud: [198 SIM cards used in fraud were seized at Morogoro, 88 of them registered by a single agent under different names](#).

August gave the national series the earlier account lacked. The regulator told Parliament it had [blocked 39,117 fraud-linked phone numbers and 6,118 domains and applications in the 2025/26 financial year, removed 7,311 violating accounts and submitted 56 security-incident reports to the police; and it identified 7,334 mobile lines linked to fraud between April and June 2026, down 25.3% from 9,817 in the preceding quarter](#), with two regions flagged as priorities and the regulator, operators and security agencies convening in August to coordinate further measures. Blocking is not prosecution: [56 incident reports stand against 39,117 numbers blocked](#), and no conviction or restitution figure is held.

The same budget statement [provides for cybercrime investigation centres at Dodoma and Zanzibar](#). Nothing is built, sited or staffed on the record, and the country still holds no published national cybersecurity strategy to place them in.

DPI

Data Exchange

The public procurement appeals authority [directed all domestic and international bidders to lodge challenges through its online module and announced plans to integrate it with the judiciary's system](#), reported 31 July, with hearings by video conference already taking cases from bidders in five other countries. No date is attached to the integration.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identity register is the most heavily integrated rail the base holds anywhere, and its coverage is flat. [Over 138 public and private institutions are integrated across banking, insurance and social security](#) – the hardest adoption figure the base carries for any African identity-verification rail. Against that, the register stands at [26.4m registered](#),

22.3m numbers issued and 20.6m cards physically distributed, about 81% of eligible adults at December 2025: counts up, percentage flat to slightly down against a growing adult denominator. The gap between numbers issued and cards in citizens' hands is 1.7m, and it did not close over the period.

The budget behind it was set out to Parliament on 19 August: the home affairs ministry put the identifier's rollout among its 2026/27 priorities under the national blueprint, alongside new district registration offices and a headquarters at Dodoma. No cost line or timetable accompanies the priority.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The mandatory electronic payments order came into operation on 1 July 2026. It is an order under the electronic transactions Act rather than regulations, as widely mis-reported; it is prospective only, businesses taking cash at commencement have until 1 January 2027 to comply, and cash remains legal tender.

One month in, the price of using the rails became the argument. On 31 July the central bank capped bank-to-wallet interoperability at TZS 5,000 above TZS 500,000, single instant transactions and retail bank-to-bank transfers at TZS 2,000, and card payments at zero, removing intra-bank transfer charges and a Zanzibar card surcharge. The same day the governor rejected a general price cap demanded by users and analysts; one analyst put the worked cost at about TZS 3,500 per TZS 100,000 paid and argued that the mandate manufactures avoidance.

A technical meeting in Zanzibar from 7 to 11 July advanced the governance, commercial and risk frameworks for a cross-border instant-payment corridor with Rwanda. No launch date was set.

August supplied the adoption side of the same picture, from two directions. The government is promoting affordable-smartphone financing to widen electronic-payment take-up, with active mobile money accounts up 7.5% to 87.05 million and smartphone penetration at 44.74% in June 2026, as the central bank directs eight business sectors to adopt electronic payment systems within six months from January 2027. And in the countryside an operator's agricultural service pays crop proceeds straight to farmers' phones, reporting more than TSh150bn paid to farmers in two southern regions in the 2025/26 season and over TSh50bn already in 2026/27, covering more than 2,000 coffee and pigeon-pea farmers in two northern regions and expanding into the southern highlands, alongside linked credit and health insurance. Every figure is the operator's own, given at a promotional exhibition at which it also awarded vehicles and phones to loyal users, and no farmer total, fee schedule or default rate on the linked credit is published.

Acceptance widened from outside as well. A commercial bank and an international card scheme opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Tanzania on 19 August, settling in local currency, US dollars or both; the merchant count is given for the nine markets together and not for Tanzania.

Registries

At an agricultural exhibition on 4 August the e-government agency stated that more than 6,000 cooperative societies are registered on its management system. No user counts, spend or timeline were given.

Birth registration gained a fourth estimate. The constitutional and legal affairs minister put under-five registration at 65%, against 55% in 2020, attributing the rise to sustained investment and awareness campaigns. The base already holds estimates of about 60% for 2022 and a five-year range of 61 to 76% on different bases, and does not reconcile them to one series.

Sectoral management information systems

At the same exhibition the agency described a farmer-records and permits system and a fertiliser monitoring system, with no user counts, spend or timeline given.

The state's own asset record is being enforced rather than built. The finance ministry is [tightening enforcement of the central electronic system for recording and monitoring public assets](#), citing a [hydropower project at about TSh6tn](#) and a [railway at about TSh10.6tn](#), with legal backing through amendments to the Public Finance Act and the Public Assets Management Regulations 2024. No count of assets recorded, entities complying or value reconciled is published, so the two named investments are cited as scale rather than as entries in the system.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The central bank [launched a sovereign yield curve system on 7 August](#), letting investors compare secondary-market government-security returns against domestic and international alternatives before investing. [Retail participation stands at 32,631 investors against 897 in 2016](#), on the governor's own figures given at the launch.

Upstream of any single system, German cooperation [tendered a consultancy on 5 August to identify and prepare bankable digital public infrastructure projects across Tanzania, Kenya and Uganda](#) — identity, data exchange, payments and e-government — under the European programme with the East African Community. A procurement notice fixes the consultancy and nothing about any project it may produce; neither value nor duration is stated.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

A [constituency digitalisation strategy opened on 4 August with 20 computers and two printers valued at TZS 100m donated by a consumer lender](#), starting with the education department's administration, inter-departmental communication and examination coordination, with secondary schools stated next and ward offices in phases over three to four years. It was announced by the ICT minister in the constituency she represents, and no funding is disclosed for any phase beyond the donated equipment.

Technology

AI

At an international AI meeting on 18 July the ICT minister stated that a [national AI data centre is under construction, justified on ending raw-data export and training models on domestic hydro and geothermal power](#), and that a Kiswahili large language model is set out in the national vision. No site, cost, capacity, operator or completion date was given for the centre, and no developer, budget, corpus or timetable for the model.

Twelve days later, at a training event on 30 July, an archives officer said [government is still drafting AI guidelines](#); an [external policy outlook published the same day placed Tanzania among states still developing a strategy](#).

Three deployments were reported. A cardiac institute stated on 16 July that its [digital patient tracking system is in use for medical-camp follow-up](#), alongside AI-enabled echocardiography and contactless vital-signs monitoring, with no patient volumes or procurement route. A peer-reviewed study published 3 August reported a ports enquiry chatbot at [95.1% weighted task success with fifteen domain experts](#), with no production deployment. At the agricultural exhibition on 4 August a university showed [a medicine-authenticity lookup at development stage and a voice-driven mobile-money service for blind users in testing](#); both are student prototypes, self-reported, with no institutional partner, regulator or funder named.

Capacity

Literacy

The telecoms regulator's director general put the [digital clubs programme at 800 clubs from nursery to university level](#), funded through the regulator and anchored in the digital economy framework, alongside its sponsorship of the national schools mathematics olympiad team. No establishment dates, per-club spend, enrolment or outcome measure is published. Separately the annual report records [1,167 certified financial educators trained and about 155,730 individuals reached](#); no prior-year figure is held, so the count stands unbenchmarked.

Training and skills

The Zanzibar postgraduate technology campus graduated its second cohort on 5 July: [129 students, about half from East Africa and 30% women, with a stated aim of 100 startups](#). The figures are institution-reported and unaudited.

Training opened in Dar es Salaam on 27 July for [110 participants from public, private and non-governmental institutions, across AI, cybersecurity, personal data protection and emerging technologies](#). No budget, duration, certification or repeat cadence was stated.

Inclusion

Access to services

Financial access points reached [2.27m, up 33.5%, of which about 2m are mobile-money agents](#) at end-December 2025 — growth that is agent build-out rather than branch build-out, as the council itself says.

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